

Who Are We? Flattered You'd Ask!

I'm Jen. I'm a wife, mom, and former healthcare professional. I'm passionate about making personal finance accessible to everyone, especially people who don't come from money or families with wealthy connections. I didn't have anyone around to teach me how to earn, invest, or manage my money. The only thing I knew about investing was that my grandmother once invested \$2,000 in penny stocks and lost it all. I didn't learn about personal finance until my husband, Travis, and I decided to pay off \$78,000 of student loan debt, then did it in two years. It was during those two years that I started sharing what I was learning with friends and family on social media. I started a blog detailing my experiences with side hustles and changing my spending habits, which led to writing about those things for dozens of other personal finance websites, being nominated for several awards, and starting *Frugal Friends Podcast* with my good friend Jill.

Hey, that's me, Jill! Co-owner, cohost and coauthor alongside Jen. I too have no finance degrees, but rather lived experience in identifying what I want from life and leveraging my resources to get it. As a licensed clinical social worker, I have never described my money situation as "robust." I graduated undergrad with \$33,000 of student loan debt, which, unfortunately, was more than what I made in a year. My husband, Eric, and I also accumulated other debts, mostly on vehicles, bringing our borrowed total to \$60,000. Through nontraditional housing (RV living and house-sitting to name a few), many side hustles, and lots of creativity, we were able to pay it all off and cash flow my master's degree in seven years. I met Jen on this journey, both of us paying off debt and desiring a safe place to talk about the joys and difficulties of this long-term goal. Our friendship made me wish that lighthearted money conversations with normal people and financial literacy were more accessible, non-shaming, and inclusive. And, so, the podcast was born.

Together we founded *Frugal Friends*, a podcast about saving money where it counts so you can spend freely on what matters. We're not wealth-building gurus and we're not here to upsell you a course or coaching program. We're real-life friends and regular people who've been practicing and fumbling at values-based spending for years. We're not perfect, but we'll share what's worked for us, what hasn't, and why, so you can make the decision to try new things on your journey. In short, we'll show our